



1ST WEEK: **DAY 5**

Baby blues

YOUR BABY TODAY

If you had a Cesarean and your baby is healthy, They'll likely come home from the hospital with you today, after passing their final in-hospital pediatric exam. Make sure you have the correct car seat and pack a blanket or two to keep them warm.

“Try to spend some time focusing on the needs of older children too and helping them to adapt to the new arrival.”

Today, you might feel emotional and weepy, known as the “baby blues.” This is caused by hormonal changes and exacerbated by fatigue and a feeling of anticlimax after the buildup to the birth. The baby blues last a day or so, and with rest and emotional support, you will start to feel better. If the feelings fail to subside after a few days, talk to your doctor since you may be suffering from [postpartum depression](#).

Your breasts will still feel tender and full today. Feeding your baby on demand (see p.448) will help relieve this. Feeling tired interferes with the “letdown” reflex (see p.449), so it's vital to rest or sleep in the day to make up for broken nights. It's important to continue breastfeeding at night to prevent milk stagnation, which leads to problems such as abscesses and [mastitis](#) (breast inflammation).

Your baby's arrival is a major adjustment for an older child, but there are ways to help them welcome their new baby brother or sister. Give your older child a gift from the baby and encourage them to help with the baby's care as is appropriate for their age. A two-year-old may want to touch the baby, hold their hand, and bring diapers and other things that are needed; a five-year-old can hold the baby with support and sing to them.